

MATTHEW O'LEARY

Print Production Lead | Publications, Packaging & Prepress

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Print production lead with 20+ years running production for magazines, CPG packaging, books, and national retail catalogs. I own the process end to end, including schedules, file standards, preflight, proofing, color, and printer relationships, and I stay hands-on in InDesign and Illustrator, building and fixing the files myself.

Most recently Designer & Production Manager for California magazine (Cal Alumni Association), running the issue from layout and ad preflight through the Quad printer relationship and post-press delivery. Focused on helping teams standardize production with templates, InDesign scripting, and AI-assisted tools, without taking creative freedom away from the artists. Available for contract, fractional, and project-based production leadership.

CORE SKILLS

- **Production Management & Systems:** End-to-end production ownership, schedules and page flow, ad and file intake, preflight standards, printer and vendor coordination, press checks, post-press archiving; Jira, Trello, Airtable
- **InDesign Automation & Templates:** JavaScript/ExtendScript scripting, GREP styles, Find/Change queries, Data Merge, parent-page and style systems, reusable templates, naming and delivery standards
- **Prepress & Color:** PDF/X preflight, Acrobat Pro, CMYK and spot/Pantone color, color separations for offset and screen printing, pagination, imposition, proofing across offset, digital, and large-format print
- **Editorial & Publications:** Magazines, alumni and custom publications, book interiors and covers, retail catalogs, typography, page mapping, proof cycles
- **Packaging & Large Format:** CPG packaging mechanicals, rigid and flexible dielines, labels, FDA-compliant copy placement, multi-SKU rollouts; paneled trade-show booths, building drapes, bus wraps, wayfinding and event signage
- **Tools:** Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Acrobat Pro, Firefly and Generative Fill; Midjourney, ChatGPT, Claude; Figma; Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint; Mailchimp; macOS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Designer & Production Manager | California Magazine (Cal Alumni Association) Aug 2026 – Present

Remote, Contract

- Own production of the magazine from layout through press, including page flow, ad preflight, image placement, and press-ready files for editorial pages, advertising, and custom inserts.
- Manage the printer relationship with Quad, from file delivery through proof approval and press, against a hard publication schedule.
- Route layouts and proofs through Creative Director and Managing Editor approval cycles and manage revisions under deadline.
- Deliver post-press file packaging and supporting digital assets using template-based and AI-assisted workflows.

Production Consultant & Designer | Matt O'Leary Design 2010 – Present

Santa Cruz, CA

- Run production for packaging, publishing, and branded-collateral clients from brief through final delivery, including FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and product labels.
- Create color separations for a screen-printing business from many kinds of starting artwork, for clients including O'Neill Surf Shop.
- Build paneled and tiled large-format files for extra-large trade-show booths, building drapes, and bus wraps.
- Coordinate print and fabrication vendors on materials, proofs, quality control, and delivery; track timelines and approvals in Trello.

Production Support Specialist | OBXtek Dec 2024 – Oct 2025

Monterey, CA

- Produced layouts, curriculum graphics, and media assets for Defense Language Institute learning modules, applying accessibility standards to government curriculum materials.

- Standardized templates and visual assets across 14+ language pipelines; coordinated deliverables, versions, and deadlines in Airtable.

Senior Designer | Wiser Solutions, Axway, Kiteworks 2014 – 2023

Remote and Palo Alto, CA

- **Senior Designer, Wiser Solutions (2022–2023):** Managed production assets and template-based design-system consistency; standardized asset handoffs across remote teams.
- **Senior Designer, Axway (2018–2022):** Built template-driven systems for global print and digital marketing campaigns, speeding delivery across distributed teams.
- **Product Designer, Kiteworks (2014–2018):** Maintained design-system standards and delivered production-ready assets with engineering.

Creative Lead | FastPencil Oct 2011 – May 2014

Campbell, CA

- Led typographic systems and production for 50+ book interiors and covers a year in InDesign and Illustrator.
- Prepared final files for commercial printers, KDP, and IngramSpark with a high rate of first-pass acceptance.

Print Production Manager | McDill Associates Sep 2008 – Nov 2011

Soquel, CA

- Managed print-production workflows and designed packaging for national retail brands including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built and verified dielines, spot-color separations, and regulated copy; coordinated printers and paper suppliers for on-time multi-SKU rollouts.
- Produced wayfinding, large-format event signage, and brand-activation materials for trade shows including PMA.

Prepress Manager | West Marine Jan 2002 – Aug 2008

Watsonville, CA

- Managed prepress for 800+ page national retail catalogs: preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, proofing, and high-volume seasonal delivery.
- Ran press checks at Midwest printers and coordinated vendors on schedule, quality, and specifications.

Co-founder | The Juice Surf Magazine 1994 – 2000

Santa Cruz, CA

- Co-founded and ran an independent quarterly surf magazine for about six years, producing roughly 20 issues from editorial through press.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz | Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies